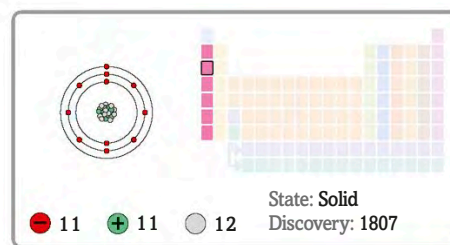


11 Na Sodium



Forms



Everyday salt contains lots of sodium.

Although abundant on Earth, sodium is never found in its pure form naturally: it forms compounds with other elements. Sodium chloride, which also contains chlorine, is the most common sodium compound. It is also known as the mineral

halite, and it is what makes seawater salty. Other sodium minerals include **sodalite**, a soft blue stone that can be shaped and polished. **Pure sodium** is soft enough to be cut with a knife. It reacts with oxygen in the air, forming a compound called sodium oxide, and bursts